New Zealand

The 16 regions, the terrain, the national parks, the towns and the highways. The number in each circle is the region's fact sheet: **NZ-A-01** to **16**.

Scale 1:1,900,000 · 1 cm on the map = 19 km · north is up.

4,993,923	267,300	16	13
people (2023 Census)	km² in the 16 regions	regions	national parks

How to read the map

- Over 1 million people
- 100,000 to 500,000
- 25,000 to 100,000
- Town or destination
- Airport with international flights
- National park (DOC)
- Peak, with its height
- State Highway 1, the main highway
- Other State Highway, with its number
- Cook Strait ferry (by sea)
- Region boundary
- Region and its fact-sheet number
- River
- Lake

Height of the land

0 · 250 · 600 · 1,000 · 1,500 · 2,000 · 2,400 m

Hill shading assumes light from the northwest: slopes in shadow are darker.

Scale 1:1,900,000

0 · 50 · 100 · 150 · 200 km

Main sectors

Dairy · Sheep · Beef cattle · Fruit · Vineyards · Vegetables · Forestry · Meat processing · Accommodation & tourism

Each sector puts its symbol on its **top 4 regions** in New Zealand (figures in the table below). Construction, maintenance, logistics and drafting follow the population: more people, more work.

Town sizes: approximate category, from Stats NZ's 2023 Census. Names are the English names on the official NZ Gazetteer (LINZ); their Māori names are listed below.

MĀORI NAMES YOU WILL SEE ON SIGNS

Aotearoa New Zealand
Te Waipounamu South Island
Kā Tiritiri o te Moana Southern Alps
Tititea Mount Aspiring
Te Rerenga Wairua Cape Reinga
Mohua Golden Bay
Mata-Au Clutha River
Te Ika-a-Māui North Island
Rakiura Stewart Island
Aoraki Mount Cook
Piopiotahi Milford Sound
Tīkapa Moana Hauraki Gulf
Te Tai-o-Aorere Tasman Bay
Waiau Franz Josef (village)

Aotearoa is the everyday Māori name for New Zealand. **Saying them:** vowels as in Spanish, ā = long a, *wh* ≈ *f*, *ng* as in *sing*. Taupō or Whangārei are Māori names used in English too.

What does each region produce?

Each region's share of the New Zealand total, in %. The darker the cell, the more concentrated the sector; in bold, the top 4 regions, which carry the sector's symbol on the map.

	Farming: livestock and hectares							Jobs, February 2025				
	Dairy	Sheep	Beef	Fruit	Vineyards	Vegetables	Forestry	Meat processing	Accommodation	Construction	Transport	Architecture & eng.
NORTH ISLAND												
1 Northland	4.8	0.7	8.3	**8.5**	n/a	5.3	7.3	2.7	3.7	3.1	2.3	1.7
2 Auckland	n/a	n/a	3.1	4.4	2.1	**15.8**	5.6	6.1	**23.2**	**34.5**	**42.0**	**43.1**
3 Waikato	**27.0**	5.6	**14.6**	3.7	0.1	**11.0**	**17.4**	10.2	**8.8**	**9.5**	**6.9**	**8.2**
4 Bay of Plenty	5.1	0.9	2.8	**37.2**	n/a	0.7	**13.9**	1.7	6.5	6.0	6.5	5.9
5 Gisborne	0.1	5.1	5.9	7.0	3.6	6.3	**8.1**	1.1	0.6	0.9	0.8	0.5
6 Hawke's Bay	1.1	10.6	**11.8**	**18.3**	**9.9**	**18.4**	**8.0**	**12.4**	3.4	3.5	3.0	2.2
7 Taranaki	**8.4**	1.8	3.1	0.2	n/a	n/a	1.7	6.7	2.3	2.2	1.9	2.4
8 Manawatū-Whanganui	7.6	**18.5**	**15.1**	0.7	0.7	8.8	7.2	**13.1**	3.0	4.4	3.4	1.6
9 Wellington	n/a	5.0	3.8	0.6	3.5	0.4	4.6	3.2	8.8	**9.4**	**7.5**	**11.1**
SOUTH ISLAND												
10 Tasman	1.2	0.8	1.0	**8.2**	2.6	1.8	2.0	0.0	1.7	1.0	0.9	0.5
11 Nelson	n/a	n/a	n/a	0.0	n/a	0.0	2.0	0.9	1.5	1.1	1.3	1.0
12 Marlborough	0.3	1.6	1.2	1.3	**67.5**	1.5	4.8	0.8	1.6	0.8	1.2	0.4
13 West Coast	2.4	0.2	0.8	0.0	n/a	0.9	2.1	1.4	3.0	0.8	0.6	0.2
14 Canterbury	**23.3**	**18.0**	**14.8**	2.6	**3.9**	**25.7**	6.5	**14.3**	**13.6**	**15.1**	**14.0**	**16.3**
15 Otago	4.9	**16.6**	8.2	5.2	**3.8**	1.2	5.7	11.4	**15.3**	6.1	4.9	3.9
16 Southland	**11.1**	**13.1**	5.4	0.2	n/a	1.6	3.2	**13.7**	3.1	1.8	2.8	0.7

Indicative sectors and areas: not current job vacancies, wages or a guarantee of work. They show where the activity is, not where jobs are open today.

Farming: livestock at 30 June 2025; fruit, vineyards, vegetables and forestry in hectares, 2022 census. Jobs: employees at their place of work (owners working alone are not counted). "n/a": suppressed by Stats NZ.

Sources: Stats NZ, Agricultural Production Statistics 2025 (AGR003AA) and Agricultural Production Census 2022; Business Demography Statistics 2025 (BDS_BDS_001), via Figure.NZ. Accessed 2026-10-21. Data in datos/sectores-nz.json.

HOW TO PUT THE MAP TOGETHER

1. **Test join first.** Print only pieces 2 and 3 at actual size (100%), single-sided, and join them as in step 3. If the ►◄ marks are less than 1 mm apart, print the other seven.
2. **Trim** the left margin of the pieces in columns 2 and 3, and the top margin of the pieces in rows 2 and 3, along the dashed line.
3. **Join each row** from left to right: lay each piece on the "glue here" strip of the one before and slide it until each pair of ►◄ marks makes a straight line. Use a glue stick, or tape on the back.
4. **Join the rows** from top to bottom: the lower row goes on top, with the ▲▼ marks lined up.

A young, restless land

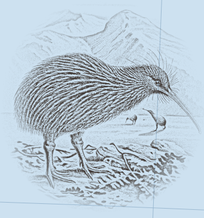
Alpine Fault The plate boundary runs about 600 km along the Southern Alps, which rise 10 mm or more a year. It last broke in 1717; there is a 75% chance of a big quake in the next 50 years.

Taupō The lake fills a supervolcano. Its Ōruanui eruption, about 25,500 years ago, threw out over 1,000 km³ of material.

Earthquakes GeoNet locates about 20,000 a year (22,904 in 2024); only 100 to 250 are strong enough to be felt.

Rain Milford Sound gets about 6,700 mm a year (9,259 mm in 2016), one of the wettest places in the country.

Kiwi, kiwi and Kiwis



The bird. Five species, none of which can fly; they are mostly active at night. The only bird with nostrils at the tip of its beak: it sniffs out worms underground. Its egg weighs up to a fifth of the mother. About 70,000 are left, and unprotected populations shrink about 2% a year.

The fruit. It began as the "Chinese gooseberry": teacher Isabel Fraser brought the seeds from China in 1904, and the vines first fruited in Whanganui in 1910. In 1959 Turners and Growers renamed it "kiwifruit" to sell it in the United States. About 80% of the crop grows in Bay of Plenty, and Te Puke calls itself the kiwifruit capital of the world.



The people. By 1917 New Zealand soldiers in the First World War were being called "Kiwis"; after the Second World War the name spread to all New Zealanders.

Drawings after J. G. Keulemans, North-Island kiwi, in W. L. Buller, A History of the Birds of New Zealand (1888), public domain; and a photo by André Karwath, CC BY-SA 2.5.

Chatham Islands
About 800 km east of Banks Peninsula, roughly level with Christchurch. Drawn at the same scale as the map, but moved from their real place. They are not one of the 16 regions: they have their own council.

Sources. Region boundaries: Stats NZ (2017) via geoBoundaries, CC BY 4.0. National parks: Department of Conservation, "DOC Public Conservation Land" (NaPALIS), CC BY 4.0, accessed 2026-10-21. State Highways and lakes: LINZ, Topo 1:250k, CC BY 4.0, downloaded 2026-10-22. Rivers and ferry: Natural Earth 1:10 m, public domain. Sectors: Stats NZ (Agricultural Production Statistics 2025, Agricultural Production Census 2022, Business Demography 2025), via Figure.NZ. Calendar: Work and Income and PickNZ. Terrain: Terrain Tiles (Mapzen, on AWS) with the LINZ elevation model (CC BY 4.0), SRTM and ETOPO1. Population: Stats NZ, 2023 Census. Names: New Zealand Gazetteer (LINZ), 2026-10-22. Heights: Aoraki/Mount Cook, 2014 survey; Taranaki Maunga, Te Kāhui Tupua Act 2025; the others, reference values. Curiosities: DOC, Te Ara, NZHistory, GeoNet, NIWA, NZKGI, AF8 and others, with links in datos/nz/curiosidades.json. Kiwi plate: J. G. Keulemans (1888), public domain. Projection NZTM2000.
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When is there seasonal work?

	SUMMER		AUTUMN			WINTER			SPRING			SUM.
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Fruit, grapes and vegetables, month by month												
Kiwifruit · Bay of Plenty	P	P	**H**	**H**	**H**	**P**	**P**	**P**	P		P	P
Apples & pears · Hawke's Bay	T	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	P	P	P	T	T	**T**	**T**
Apples & pears · Nelson-Tasman	T	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	P	P	P	T	T	**T**	**T**
Cherries · Central Otago	**H**		H	P	P	P	P	P				**H**
Stonefruit · Central Otago	**H**	**H**	**H**		P	P	P	P				
Avocados · Northland	**H**	**H**	**H**	P	P	P	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**
Hops · Tasman			**H**	**H**			M	M	M	M	M	M
Grapes · Wairarapa	T	T	H	H	**P**	**P**	**P**	**P**	M	M	M	M
Vegetables · Horowhenua	T	H	H	H	P	H	H	H	H	H	H	H
Other work, general season												
Meat processing												
Lambing & shearing												
Dairy farms												
Forestry												
Vineyards (Marlborough & others)												
Ski fields												
Tourism, high season												
Fishing & seafood												

H harvest (picking) · **P** pruning · **T** thinning · **M** plant maintenance · outlined: busiest months. Indicative windows: seasons change with the crop, the weather, the employer and the year. In Marlborough, vineyards offer work almost all year round (PickNZ), with no official monthly calendar.

Sources: Work and Income, "Fruit and vegetable seasonal work" and "Finding seasonal work"; PickNZ. Accessed 2026-10-21. Data in datos/calendario-nz.json.

A short history

c. 1250–1300 Polynesian voyagers, the ancestors of Māori, settle the islands.
1642 Dutch navigator Abel Tasman sights the coast; after a clash in Golden Bay he leaves without landing.
1769 James Cook lands at Tūranganui-a-Kiwa (Gisborne) and goes on to map both islands.
1840 The Treaty of Waitangi is first signed at Waitangi, Bay of Islands, on 6 February: now Waitangi Day.
1893 The first self-governing country where all women can vote in national elections.
1953 Edmund Hillary and Tenzing Norgay reach the top of Everest.
1987 Te reo Māori becomes an official language.
2011 The Christchurch earthquake of 22 February kills 185 people.

Kiwi English you will hear

dairy corner shop
tramping hiking
jandals flip-flops
chilly bin cooler box
ute pickup (utility vehicle)
chur thanks
smoko tea break at work
bach holiday house (crib in the far south)
togs swimsuit
gumboots rubber boots
sweet as all good, no worries
heaps lots

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Southern Hemisphere seasons:** summer from December to February, autumn from March to May, winter from June to August and spring from September to November.
- **What this map is for:** finding your way and planning. It does not confirm jobs, wages or visa conditions: check those on immigration.govt.nz and in each job ad.
- **Dates:** parks, sectors and calendar accessed on 2026-10-21; LINZ highways, lakes and names, and the facts in the curiosity boxes, on 2026-10-22; population from the 2023 Census.

ON THE MAP

A Tāne Mahuta, Waipoua Forest. New Zealand's largest known living kauri tree: about 51 m tall, 13.8 m around and some 1,500 years old.
B Waitomo Caves. The glowworms are larvae of a fungus gnat found only in New Zealand; they glow to lure insects into sticky threads.
C Hobbiton, near Matamata. The Shire set from The Lord of the Rings and The Hobbit films, on a family farm. Tours run daily.
D Arthur's Pass. Home of the kea, the world's only alpine parrot, now nationally endangered. Clever and curious: never feed them.
E Kawarau Bridge, near Queenstown. The world's first commercial bungy jump (43 m), opened by AJ Hackett and Henry van Asch in 1988.

NORTH ISLAND
SOUTH ISLAND
TASMAN SEA
PACIFIC OCEAN
Cape Reinga
Bay of Islands
Kaitaia
Kerikeri
Paihia
Dargaville
Whangārei
NORTHLAND
AUCKLAND
Great Barrier Island
Hauraki Gulf
Coromandel Peninsula
Auckland
Whitianga
Thames
Pukekohe
Waitakere
Hamilton
Tauranga
Bay of Plenty
Matamata
Te Puke
Whakatāne
Ōpōtiki
East Cape
Cambridge
WAIKATO
Waitomo Caves
Tokoroa
Rotorua
Lake Rotorua
RAUKŪMARA RANGE
BAY OF PLENTY
Taupō
Lake Taupō
Gisborne
GISBORNE
Tūrangi
VOLCANIC PLATEAU
Wairoa
Hawke Bay
Ngāuruhoe
Tongariro NP
Mount Ruapehu
2,797 m
New Plymouth
Taranaki Maunga
2,518 m
TARANAKI
Ohakune
Hāwera
Te Papa-Kura-o-Taranaki
Whanganui NP
MANAWATŪ-WHANGANUI
Napier
Hastings
HAWKE'S BAY
RUAHINE RANGE
Whanganui
Palmerston North
Levin
Paraparaumu
Masterton
TARARUA RANGE
Porirua
Lower Hutt
Wellington
WELLINGTON
Golden Bay
Abel Tasman NP
Tākaka
Tasman Bay
Marlborough Sounds
Motueka
NELSON
Nelson
Picton
Blenheim
MARLBOROUGH
Tapuae-o-Uenuku
2,885 m
Cook Strait
Kahurangi NP
Westport
TASMAN
Nelson Lakes NP
Paparoa NP
WEST COAST
SOUTHERN ALPS
KAIKŌURA RANGES
Kaikōura
Greymouth
Hanmer Springs
Hokitika
Arthur's Pass NP
Pegasus Bay
Christchurch
Akaroa
Banks Peninsula
Westland NP
Franz Josef
Mount Cook
3,724 m
Mount Cook NP
Methven
CANTERBURY PLAINS
Ashburton
Haast
Mount Aspiring NP
Mount Aspiring
3,033 m
Lake Pukaki
Tekapo
CANTERBURY
Twizel
Timaru
Waitaki
Canterbury Bight
Milford Sound
Fiordland NP
Wānaka
Lake Wanaka
Queenstown
Cromwell
CENTRAL OTAGO
Oamaru
Lake Te Anau
Te Anau
Alexandra
Clutha
OTAGO
Dunedin
FIORDLAND
SOUTHLAND
Gore
Balclutha
Invercargill
THE CATLINS
Bluff
Foveaux Strait
Oban
Rakiura NP
Stewart Island